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AI



Mistral's Le Chat chatbot gets a productivity push with new 'deep research' mode

MISTRAL AI

French AI lab [Mistral](#) introduced a range of new features to its Le Chat chatbot on Thursday that bring it closer to the capabilities of rivals like OpenAI and Google. The new update includes a new “deep research” mode, native multilingual reasoning, and advanced image editing.

The news comes a couple days after [Mistral released Voxtral](#), its first open source AI audio model that’s capable of reasoning in multiple languages, transcription, and more. Voxtral is also available via Le Chat.

Mistral says its new deep research mode, like those offered by rivals, turns Le Chat into a coordinated research assistant that can plan, clarify your needs, search, and synthesize data.

“What the model does is really go and look into a big variety of sources on the web to answer a specific question,” Mistral’s head of product, Elisa Salamanca, told TechCrunch. “We believe this feature is going to be very relevant for both consumer and enterprise use cases. For consumers, because it can research travel and provide an exhaustive analysis of the best travel plans. And for enterprise work, it can do exhaustive research.”

While the updates are available across all tiers — Free, Pro, Team, and Enterprise — Salamanca notes that Mistral is focusing on integrating Le Chat and

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Mistral’s productivity suite into enterprise ecosystems with this release. That’s in large part because Mistral handles data connectors differently than competitors.

“A lot of customers who have very sensitive data don’t actually use cloud services, or if they do, they do it on their own premises with virtual private clouds,” Salamanca said, citing customers in banking, defense, and government.

To address this, Salamanca said Mistral’s Le Chat and productivity suite connect to enterprise data on-premises. In other words, companies can use Le Chat’s deep reasoning and other capabilities to analyze their own internal data without having to upload anything to the cloud. That’s a meaningful differentiator against cloud-native LLM platforms like OpenAI, which is Azure-hosted, and Gemini, which is Google Cloud-based. It also opens the door for Mistral to offer other productivity tools.

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“A big part of our value proposition, especially when we release Le Chat Enterprise, is that we want to make [things like] Microsoft Excel and Google Docs and that kind of office suite work seamlessly with our capabilities,” Salamanca said. “So the connectors that we release with Le Chat Enterprise are actually one step in that direction. We’re building these connectors internally because we believe this is going to be a key for using Le Chat as a productivity enabler in the business context.”

Aside from deep reasoning, Le Chat has gotten other updates today. While users have been able to use Le Chat to reason through complex questions via [Magistral](#), Mistral’s new reasoning AI model, that capability was previously only available in English. Now Mistral natively supports multilingual reasoning in languages like French, Spanish, Japanese, and others. Mistral says Le Chat can also code-switch between languages midsentence.

This latest update from Mistral also includes the addition of Projects, which helps users stay organized by grouping chats, documents, and ideas into focused spaces. Each project can have its own default library and remember which tools and settings a user has enabled. Mistral says use cases include planning a move, designing a new product feature, or keeping work-related projects on track.

Finally, Le Chat is getting improved image-editing capabilities. This allows users to create and edit images with prompts like “remove the object” or “place me in another city.”

The new features put Mistral in a more competitive range with the AI industry’s frontrunners, positioning Le Chat as not just a model demo, but also a full-stack contender.



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AI



Mistral releases its AI assistant on iOS and Android

Romain Dillet — 7:05 AM PST · February 6, 2025

Mistral, the company sometimes considered **Europe's great hope for AI**, is releasing several updates to its AI assistant, [Le Chat](#). In addition to a major web interface upgrade, the company is releasing a mobile app on [iOS](#) and [Android](#).

As a reminder, Mistral develops its own large language models. The company's flagship models, such as [Mistral Large](#) or its multimodal model [Pixtral Large](#), are available for commercial use through an API or cloud partner, such as Azure AI Studio, Amazon Bedrock, and Google's Vertex AI. It also releases a number of open-weight models under the Apache 2.0 license.

Mistral hopes to position itself as a credible alternative to OpenAI or Anthropic. In addition to developing foundation models, its Le Chat assistant competes directly with ChatGPT, Claude, Google Gemini, and Microsoft Copilot.

Mistral is finally releasing a mobile version of the assistant to better compete for a coveted spot on your phone's home screen. The mobile app features the usual chatbot interface. You can query Mistral's AI model and ask follow-up questions in a simple conversation-like interface.

Over the last few months, Le Chat has evolved to become a competent AI assistant. In [November 2024](#), Mistral added support for web search with citations. It also lets you generate images or

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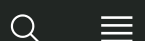
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With today's update to Le Chat, Mistral is also introducing a Pro tier for \$14.99 per month, or €14.99 per month in Europe. While the company is no longer detailing the exact AI model it is using under the hood, it says the Pro plan comes with access to the "highest-performing model," which suggests that free accounts don't have access to the top-of-the-line model.



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Other benefits include higher limits across the board and the ability to opt out of sharing your data with Mistral — the company is bringing the pay-or-consent model to AI assistants.

Up to 1,000 words per second

What makes Mistral stand out? The company doesn't claim that it has better models than the competition. But it asserts that, from a product standpoint, it can sometimes outperform its competitors.

For instance, Mistral states that Le Chat runs on “the fastest inference engines on the planet” and it can answer up to 1,000 words per second. In our usage, it indeed felt faster than using ChatGPT's 4o model.

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Mistral also claims that it generates much better images than ChatGPT or Grok. The reason Mistral performs well on this front is that it relies on Black Forest Labs' Flux Ultra, one of the leading image-generation models.

Those are nice-to-have features, but one of the main distinguishing factors comes with Le Chat's enterprise solution. Mistral lets you deploy Le Chat in your environment with custom models and a custom user interface.

If you work in defense or banking, you may need to be able to deploy an AI assistant on premise. That is not currently possible with ChatGPT Enterprise or Claude Enterprise. That will help when it comes to growing the company's revenue.

But first, let's see if Mistral's mobile app can persuade some AI enthusiasts to try its chatbot. As of this writing, ChatGPT, DeepSeek, and Google Gemini hold the No. 2, No. 3, and No. 6 spots, respectively, among the [most downloaded iPhone apps](#) in the U.S.

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Romain Dillet

Senior Reporter |

Romain Dillet was a Senior Reporter at TechCrunch until April 2025. He has written over 3,500 articles on technolo...

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Mistral releases a pair of AI reasoning models

Kyle Wiggers — 7:56 AM PDT · June 10, 2025

MISTRAL AI

French AI lab Mistral is getting into the reasoning AI model game.

On Tuesday morning, Mistral [announced](#) Magistral, its first family of reasoning models. Like other reasoning models — e.g. OpenAI's [o3](#) and Google's [Gemini 2.5 Pro](#) — Magistral works through problems step-by-step for improved consistency and reliability across topics such as math and physics.

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Magistral comes in two flavors: Magistral Small and Magistral Medium. Magistral Small is 24 billion parameters in size, and is available for download from the AI dev platform Hugging Face under a permissive Apache 2.0 license. (Parameters are the internal components of a model that guide its behavior.) Magistral Medium, a more capable model, is in preview on Mistral's Le Chat chatbot platform and the company's API, as well as third-party partner clouds.

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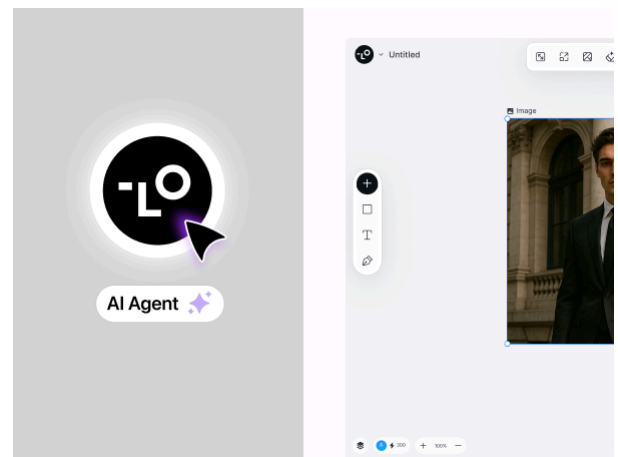
“[Magistral is] suited for a wide range of enterprise use cases, from structured calculations and programmatic logic to decision trees and rule-based systems,” writes Mistral in the blog post. “[The models are] fine-tuned for multi-step logic, improving interpretability and providing a traceable thought process in the user’s language.”

Founded in 2023, Mistral is a frontier model lab building a range of AI-powered services, including the aforementioned Le Chat and mobile apps. It’s backed by venture investors like General Catalyst, and has raised over €1.1 billion (roughly \$1.24 billion) to date.

Despite its formidable resources, Mistral has lagged behind other leading AI labs in certain areas, like developing reasoning models. Magistral doesn’t appear to be an especially competitive release, either, judging by Mistral’s own benchmarks.

On GPQA Diamond and AIME, tests that evaluate a model’s physics, math, and science skills, Magistral Medium underperforms Gemini 2.5 Pro and Anthropic’s Claude Opus 4. Magistral Medium also fails to surpass Gemini 2.5 Pro on a popular programming benchmark, LiveCodeBench.

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Perhaps that’s why Mistral touts Magistral’s other strengths in its blog post. Magistral delivers answers at “10x” the speed of competitors in Le Chat, Mistral claims, and supports a wide array of languages, including Italian, Arabic, Russian, and Simplified Chinese.

“Building on our flagship models, Magistral is designed for research, strategic planning, operational optimization, and data-driven decision making,” the company writes in its post, “whether executing risk assessment and modelling with multiple factors, or calculating optimal delivery windows under constraints.”

The release of Magistral comes after Mistral debuted a “vibe coding” client, Mistral Code. A few weeks prior to that, [Mistral](#) launched several coding-focused models and rolled out Le Chat Enterprise, a corporate-focused chatbot service that offers tools like an AI agent builder and integrates Mistral’s models with third-party services like Gmail and SharePoint.

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Kyle Wiggers

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Kyle Wiggers was TechCrunch’s AI Editor until June 2025.
His writing has appeared in VentureBeat and Digital...

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